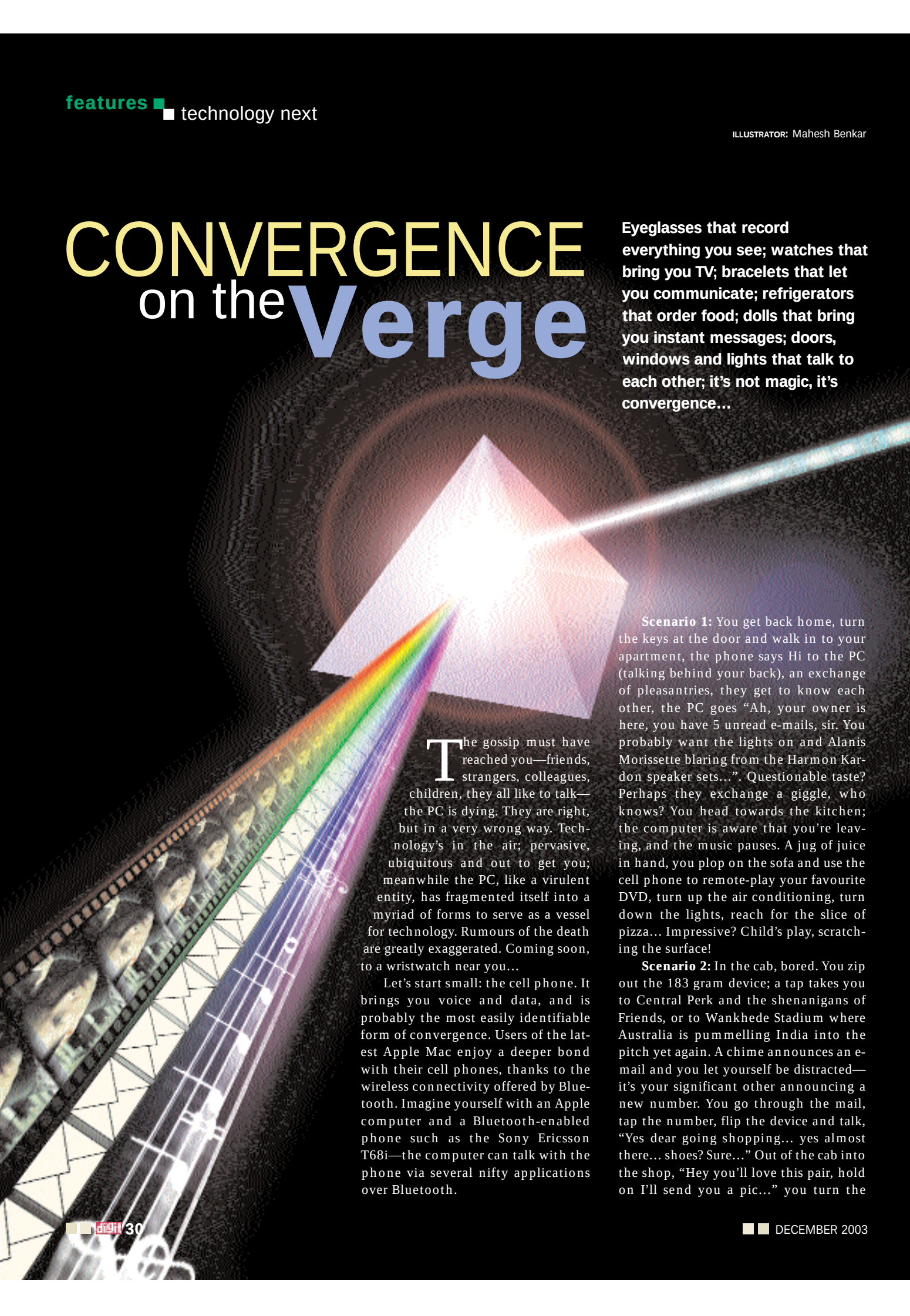


CONVERGENCE on the **V**erge

Eyeglasses that record everything you see; watches that bring you TV; bracelets that let you communicate; refrigerators that order food; dolls that bring you instant messages; doors, windows and lights that talk to each other; it's not magic, it's convergence...



The gossip must have reached you—friends, strangers, colleagues, children, they all like to talk—the PC is dying. They are right, but in a very wrong way. Technology's in the air; pervasive, ubiquitous and out to get you; meanwhile the PC, like a virulent entity, has fragmented itself into a myriad of forms to serve as a vessel for technology. Rumours of the death are greatly exaggerated. Coming soon, to a wristwatch near you...

Let's start small: the cell phone. It brings you voice and data, and is probably the most easily identifiable form of convergence. Users of the latest Apple Mac enjoy a deeper bond with their cell phones, thanks to the wireless connectivity offered by Bluetooth. Imagine yourself with an Apple computer and a Bluetooth-enabled phone such as the Sony Ericsson T68i—the computer can talk with the phone via several nifty applications over Bluetooth.

Scenario 1: You get back home, turn the keys at the door and walk in to your apartment, the phone says Hi to the PC (talking behind your back), an exchange of pleasantries, they get to know each other, the PC goes "Ah, your owner is here, you have 5 unread e-mails, sir. You probably want the lights on and Alanis Morissette blaring from the Harmon Kar-don speaker sets..." Questionable taste? Perhaps they exchange a giggle, who knows? You head towards the kitchen; the computer is aware that you're leaving, and the music pauses. A jug of juice in hand, you plop on the sofa and use the cell phone to remote-play your favourite DVD, turn up the air conditioning, turn down the lights, reach for the slice of pizza... Impressive? Child's play, scratching the surface!

Scenario 2: In the cab, bored. You zip out the 183 gram device; a tap takes you to Central Perk and the shenanigans of Friends, or to Wankhede Stadium where Australia is pummelling India into the pitch yet again. A chime announces an e-mail and you let yourself be distracted—it's your significant other announcing a new number. You go through the mail, tap the number, flip the device and talk, "Yes dear going shopping... yes almost there... shoes? Sure..." Out of the cab into the shop, "Hey you'll love this pair, hold on I'll send you a pic..." you turn the